

Current **privacy scales** do not fully consider **teenage users'** unique concerns. Following our literature review findings, we seek to address this gap by **translating qualitative findings** on said concerns into a **quantitative scale** to assess privacy designs on social media platforms.

Keywords: Privacy Concerns, Teenagers, Social Media

Online Privacy Concerns and the Teenage Perspective: Comprehensive Review and Next Steps Towards Teen-Centered Design of Social Media Platforms

Tomas Russo^{1,6}, Tubal Theodros^{2,6}, Aadit Gupta^{3,6}, Kayla Booth^{4,6}, and Oshrat Ayalon^{5,6}

¹Rutgers University, ²University of Washington, ³Penn State, ⁴The University of Texas at Austin, ⁵Max Planck Institute for Software Systems, ⁶iSchool Inclusion Institute

Objectives

Broad: Augmenting teen-centered, qualitative approaches to understand teenage users' privacy concerns at scale.

Concrete: Reviewing prior work to learn about existing privacy scales in general, and in the context of teens in particular.

Privacy Scales and Teens

- Privacy scales across studies share several dimensions, such as *awareness*, *collection*, and *control*.
- There is a call for a teen-centered privacy design, prioritizing teens opinions on what they believe will increase their online safety [1].
- While teens and adults share some privacy concerns, such as worries of companies selling their data, other privacy aspects differ between the populations and are more prominent for teens than for adults:
 - Heightened social pressure to disclose
 - Privacy conceptions

Gaps in Literature

- Privacy scales' dimensions were mostly developed with adults.
- Consequently, teenage users' unique concerns and experiences were possibly overlooked in quantitative work.
- Privacy-related scales with teens explore relatively general context or privacy management practices [2].

Future Work Plan

- Reviewing qualitative studies on teenage privacy concerns to identify those that are unique to teenage users
- Developing a scale for teens leaning on quantitative work - and - developing new measures based on findings from qualitative work
- Using the scale to explore current social-media platforms and learning about teens concerns of these platforms

References

- [1] Wisniewski, P. (2018). The privacy paradox of adolescent online safety: A matter of risk prevention or risk resilience? IEEE Security & Privacy, 16(2), 86-90.
- [2] Santer, N. D., Manago, A., Starks, A., & Reich, S. M. (2021). Early Adolescents' Perspectives on Digital Privacy. In Algorithmic Rights and Protections for Children. PubPub.



Acknowledgment. This project was generously funded by the Andrew W. Mellon Foundation. We thank the iSchool Inclusion Institute Leadership Team for their guidance in the writing of this paper.